

Password reset email: setup guide

Owner's Suite · penthousefantasy.com · prepared 5 Oct 2026 · about 30 minutes of clicking, plus DNS wait time

Where things stand

The code is done. Only the email account and three settings are missing.

The whole flow is built and tested: "Forgot your password?" on the sign-in page, a reset link that works once and lasts 2 hours, the `/reset` page, and limits on how often it can be used. But the live API reports `"email_provider": "dry-run"` (checked today), so **no email ever goes out**.

What a locked-out user sees today: "Email is not wired up yet, so nothing was sent. Ask the owner for a reset link."

Your workaround today: `/admin` → find the account → **Reset link**, then email that link yourself, **only to the address on the account**. Never send it to a different address, because whoever has the link can take over the account.

What turns it on: a free **Resend** account (Resend is the email service the code already uses), proof to Resend that you own penthousefantasy.com (a few DNS records at Squarespace), and three environment variables on Render. **No code changes and no redeploy of the website.**

Note: on 28 Sep you paused Resend (for reset mail and the email list). This guide un-pauses it for reset mail only. Turning it on does **not** start any newsletter or weekly email: those only send if someone runs a command by hand with `--send`.

Checklist

- ☐ 1. Create a Resend account
- ☐ 2. Add the domain in Resend
- ☐ 3. Add DNS records at Squarespace
- ☐ 4. Verify the domain
- ☐ 5. Create an API key
- ☐ 6. Set 3 variables on Render
- ☐ 7. Check the health page
- ☐ 8. Send yourself a real reset
- ☐ 9. (Recommended) Set the support address on Vercel

The steps

1. Create a Resend account.

Go to **resend.com** and sign up (your Gmail is fine). The free plan is plenty for reset emails; it covers a few thousand emails a month. Check their pricing page for the current limit.

2. Add your domain in Resend.

Domains → **Add Domain** → type `penthousefantasy.com`. Pick any region (US East is fine).

Resend then shows a list of DNS records. **Keep this page open** for the next step.

3. Add those DNS records at Squarespace.

Squarespace → **Domains** → penthousefantasy.com → **DNS** → **Custom records** → **Add record**, once for each record Resend lists. They usually look like this, but **copy the exact values from Resend**:

Type	Host (in Squarespace)	Value	Purpose
TXT	resend._domainkey	long key starting p=MIGf...	DKIM: proves the email is really from you
MX	send	feedback-smtp.us-east-1.amazonaws.com, priority 10	handles bounces
TXT	send	v=spf1 include:amazonses.com ~all	SPF: allowed senders
TXT (add this one too)	_dmarc	v=DMARC1; p=none;	helps Gmail trust you, keeps links out of spam

Do not touch the existing `A @` and `CNAME www` records. They point the site at Vercel. And do not re-add the "Squarespace Defaults" preset (it broke Safari before). In the Host box type only the part shown above; Squarespace adds `.penthousefantasy.com` itself.

4. Verify the domain in Resend.

Back on the Resend domain page, click **Verify DNS Records**. It often takes a few minutes but can take a few hours. Wait until every row says **Verified**. If one stays pending for over an hour, re-check that record's Host for typos.

5. Create an API key.

Resend → **API Keys** → **Create API Key**. Name it `render-prod`, permission **Sending access**, domain **penthousefantasy.com**. Copy the key (it starts with `re_`). **It is shown only once**. Paste it straight into Render (next step) and nowhere else: not in chat, a doc or the repo.

6. Add three environment variables on Render.

Render dashboard → the API service (`edge-api`) → **Environment** → **Add Environment Variable**:

Key	Value
EDGE_EMAIL_PROVIDER	resend
RESEND_API_KEY	the <code>re_...</code> key from step 5
EDGE_EMAIL_FROM	Owner's Suite <noreply@penthousefantasy.com>

Save Changes and let Render redeploy (a few minutes). The From address must end in `@penthousefantasy.com` (the domain you just verified), or Resend refuses the email. `EDGE_WEB_URL` is already correct (`https://penthousefantasy.com`), so the links will open the real site.

7. Check the health page.

Open `https://edge-api-gi8d.onrender.com/api/health`. Look for `"email_provider": "resend"`. If it still says `dry-run`, the variable didn't save or the redeploy hasn't finished.

8. Send yourself a real reset (the actual test).

In a private/incognito window: `penthousefantasy.com` → **Sign in** → **Forgot your password?** → enter `ahicks5.nd@gmail.com`.

Working: the screen says "If that address has an account, a link is on its way." The email "Reset your Owner's Suite password" arrives (check Spam the first time). Click the link, set a new password, and you're signed in.

Not working: the screen says "Email is not wired up yet...". Go to Resend → **Emails / Logs**, which will show the refusal reason. Usual causes: domain not verified yet, a typo in the key, or a From address not on the verified domain.

Limit: 3 reset emails per address per hour. If you test more than that, wait an hour. Each new link cancels nothing until it's used; using one cancels all the others.

9. (Recommended) Set the support address on Vercel.

`NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPPORT_EMAIL` is the "Still locked out? Email ..." line on the forgot screen, and the contact on the legal pages. I couldn't confirm from here whether it's set on the live site. Vercel → the project → **Settings** → **Environment Variables** → add `NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPPORT_EMAIL` for **Production** → then **Redeploy** (it's baked in at build time, so saving alone does nothing).

Use an inbox you actually read. Options: your Gmail, or `support@penthousefantasy.com` using Squarespace's free **email forwarding** to your Gmail. That forwarding doesn't conflict with the Resend records, which sit on `send.`, not on the main domain. Don't use `noreply@`; nobody receives mail there.

If something goes wrong

Symptom	Fix
Health still says <code>dry-run</code>	Variable not saved, or Render hasn't finished redeploying.
Health says <code>resend</code> but the screen says "not wired up"	Resend refused the email. Check Resend → Logs. The app hides the error on purpose, so it never reveals which addresses have accounts.

Email lands in Spam	Make sure the <code>_dmarc</code> record is in; new domains warm up over a few days. Ask testers to mark it "Not spam."
Link says expired / already used	Links last 2 hours and work once. Request a new one.
Want to turn it off fast	On Render set <code>EDGE_EMAIL_PROVIDER</code> to <code>dry-run</code> . Everything falls back to the manual <code>/admin</code> link.

After it works (optional, for later)

Tell me it's live, and I'll (a) tick off AC-9 in `TASKS.md` and update `docs/ACCOUNTS.md` / `docs/HANDOFF.md`, and (b) if you want, build **email verification** (AC-13), which is a "confirm your address" link at sign-up. The same Resend setup makes that possible, and it closes the gap where someone can register with an email address they don't own.